Table 2.1: Total Number of Plant groups in the World and India		
Plant group	**Number of known species**	
	World#	**India***
Algae	40,000	7,357
Bryophytes	16,236	2,748
Pteridophytes	12,000	1,289
Gymnosperms	1,012	79
Angiosperms	2,68,600	18,386

** Singh, P. and Dash, S.S. 2017-Plants discoveries 2016-New Genera, species and new records, BSI, India.*
Chapman, A.D. 2009. Number of living species in Australia and the world 2nd edition. Australian government, Department of environment, water Heritage and Arts.

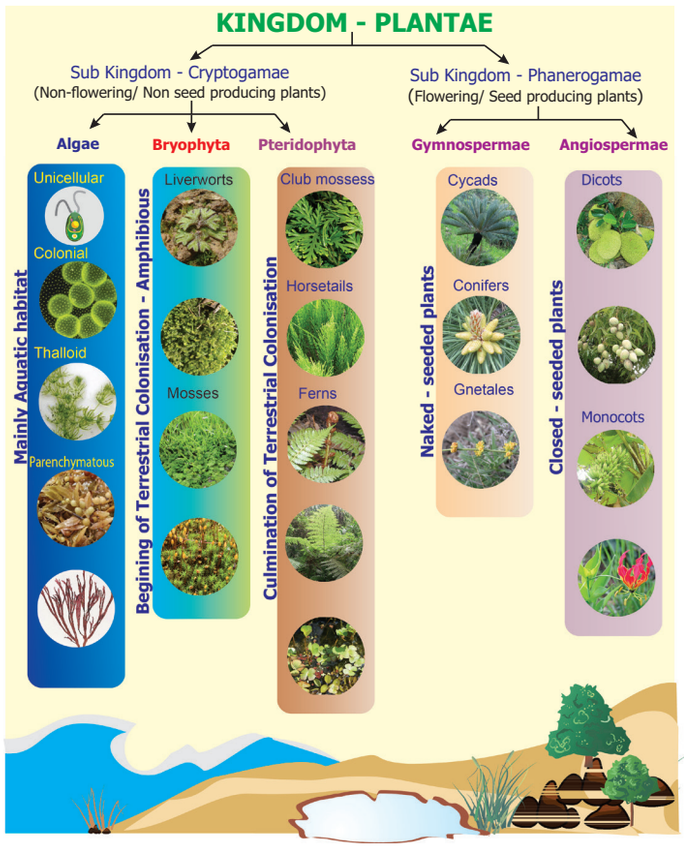


Figure 2.1: Classification of Plant Kingdom

2.2 Life Cycle Patterns in Plants

Alternation of Generation

Alternation of generation is common in all plants. Alternation of the haploid gametophytic phase (n) with diploid sporophytic phase (2n) during the life cycle is called alternation of generation. Following type of life cycles are found in plants (Figure 2.2).

Haplontic Life Cycle

Gametophytic phase is dominant, photosynthetic and independent, whereas sporophytic phase is represented by the zygote. Zygote undergoes meiosis to restore haploid condition. Example: *Volvox*, *Spirogyra*.

Diplontic Life Cycle

Sporophytic phase (2n) is dominant, photosynthetic and independent. The gametophytic phase is represented by the single to few celled gametophyte.

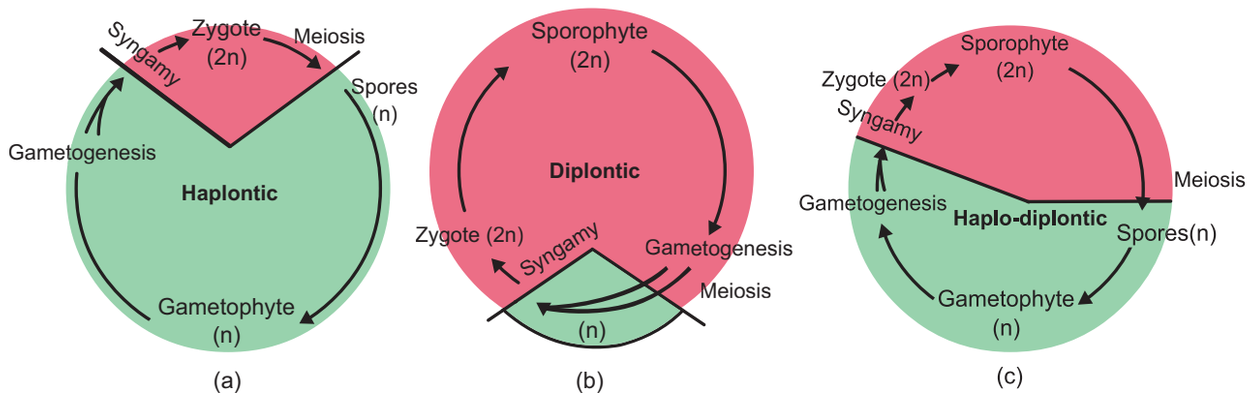


Figure 2.2: Life cycle patterns in plants a) Haplontic, b) Diplontic, c) Haplo-diplontic

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